

Area of Study 4 – Fusion

The emphasis here is on how two or more musical cultures are combined to create a fusion. Some fusions have become genres in their own right such as Bhangra and Salsa. The core understanding is for students to examine how the separate musical elements are treated in a fusion work. The two set works provide contrast. The Afro Celt Sound System: 'Release' and 'Samba Em Preludio' by Esperanza Spalding are designed to explore how fusions create new, popular styles.

The suggested wider listening pieces cover African, Celtic, Afro-Cuban Jazz and Latin American styles, showcasing the variety and uniqueness of different fusion styles.

Set works

It is recommended that students familiarise themselves with each set work as a whole, before learning to identify important musical elements and aspects of continuity and change between works.

Understanding of the musical elements, musical contexts and musical language will help to identify the historical, social and cultural contexts, and illuminate elements of continuity and change between the works.

Students need to learn how to write perceptively about music, in particular comparing, contrasting, assessing, evaluating and commenting as appropriate.

The eight set works have been chosen to be representative of typical pieces from their areas of study. These pieces should be studied and analysed so that the students have a good understanding of the stylistic features and conventions of each piece.

Students should be encouraged to express their ideas about the set works using appropriate and correct musical vocabulary.

The areas of study and set works are:

Area of study	Set works
Instrumental Music 1700–1820	• J S Bach: 3rd Movement from Brandenburg Concerto no. 5 in D major • L van Beethoven: 1st Movement from Piano Sonata no. 8 in C minor 'Pathétique'
Vocal Music	• H Purcell: Music for a While • Queen: Killer Queen (from the album 'Sheer Heart Attack')
Music for Stage and Screen	• S Schwartz: Defying Gravity (from the album of the cast recording of Wicked) • J Williams: Main title/rebel blockade runner (from the soundtrack to Star Wars Episode IV: A New Hope)
Fusions	• Afro Celt Sound System: Release (from the album 'Volume 2: Release') • Esperanza Spalding: Samba Em Preludio (from the album 'Esperanza')

Suggested wider listening and unfamiliar pieces

Students should listen to and be able to appraise unfamiliar pieces of music as part of this component. The examples of suggested wider listening in *Appendix 4: Suggested wider listening* (and other pieces) are provided to support students' preparation for appraising unfamiliar pieces of music.

Unfamiliar pieces of music are neither set works nor suggested wider listening. Unfamiliar music will have similar stylistic characteristics to the set works. Studying other pieces of music (suggested wider listening and others) will provide breadth to support learning these stylistic characteristics.

Students should apply their appraising skills and knowledge of musical elements, musical contexts and musical language to these pieces of unfamiliar music in the examination. They should learn how to listen perceptively to unfamiliar music, developing their skills of aural analysis. In particular they should be able to place the music in a wider context and chronology (which could include identifying the genre, composer and date of composition), recognise chords and keys, and complete simple aural dictation tasks.

The pieces given as suggested wider listening for each area of study are designed to provide further examples of music from that period or musical tradition and provide breadth as well as depth to each area of study. These works provide a useful framework for a wider study of the set works. Their purpose is to show the common features of the set works in other music, so that each set work is not just seen in isolation. These pieces of suggested wider listening do not need to be examined in as much depth as the set works.

The suggested wider listening is not compulsory to study. Teachers may use the pieces listed in *Appendix 4: Suggested wider listening* or they may make their own selection of pieces of music to supplement the areas of study.

Assessment information

- This is an externally set and assessed examination
- First assessment: May/June 2018.
- This component consists of 80 marks.
- The assessment is 1 hour and 45 minutes.
- The assessment consists of nine questions.
- Students must answer all questions.
- The paper will include multiple-choice, short open, and extended writing questions.